



PERIOD INSOMNIA

How PMS and PMDD Affect Sleep

Many people notice changes in their sleep during the days leading up to their period. Some may feel unusually tired, while others have trouble falling asleep or staying asleep. This experience is sometimes called period insomnia.

Period insomnia typically happens during the week before menstruation, when hormone levels shift in the body.

PMS and PMDD

Many people experience premenstrual syndrome (PMS) before their period begins. PMS can cause a range of physical and emotional symptoms in the days leading up to menstruation.

Common PMS symptoms may include:

- Bloating
- Breast tenderness
- Headaches
- Mood changes
- Fatigue
- Appetite changes
- Difficulty sleeping

About 90% of people who menstruate experience PMS symptoms, although the severity can vary.

A more severe form of PMS is premenstrual dysphoric disorder (PMDD). PMDD affects a smaller percentage of people but can cause stronger emotional symptoms that interfere with daily life.

Why Hormones Affect Sleep

Sleep changes before a period are mainly linked to hormonal fluctuations during the late luteal phase of the menstrual cycle.

During this phase:

- Progesterone levels rise
- Melatonin levels may decrease in people with PMS or PMDD

Hormonal changes may also alter sleep patterns, causing:

- More light sleep
- Less REM sleep
- Increased daytime tiredness

Tips for Better Sleep Before Your Period

Helpful strategies include:

- Exercising regularly, preferably earlier in the day
- Getting natural sunlight each day
- Maintaining a consistent sleep schedule
- Keeping the bedroom cool, quiet, and dark
- Limiting caffeine several hours before bedtime
- Avoiding alcohol or nicotine before sleep
- Developing a relaxing bedtime routine

If sleep problems become severe or persistent, a healthcare provider may recommend therapy, medication, or hormonal management.

Key Takeaway

Sleep disturbances before menstruation are often linked to hormonal changes during the menstrual cycle. While many people experience mild sleep disruption before their period, healthy sleep habits can help improve rest and overall well-being.

If symptoms are severe or interfere with daily life, it may be helpful to consult a healthcare professional.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

*Educational content informed by National Library of Medicine. Research on sleep disturbances and premenstrual syndrome.
Jehan, S., et al. (2016). Sleep and Premenstrual Syndrome. Journal of Sleep Medicine and Disorders.
Jeon, B., & Baek, J. (2023). Menstrual disturbances and sleep disturbances: A systematic review. BMC Women's Health.*